

NZ GORHAM, ENGW 1101, 7/2/25

RELATIONSHIPS CHANGE

Friends are good
Some are bad
Old ones go
New ones come
That is life
That's all right
Friends do change
I do too
I am sad
I'll be fine

OPPENHEIMER

Oppenheimer constructed an atomic bomb
so he and other people can watch
the bomb burst in a desert territory.
The bomb made a bright orange flash,
making a loud sound, blowing strong
winds towards the audience watching,
and wiping out the dry sand ground.
Everyone, including Oppenheimer,
cheered with pride and had
proud smiles on their faces.
But Oppenheimer saw a terrible vision
of the future—people getting wiped away
from the bomb that he created from the war.
Feeling very guilty from what he invented,
he said “I am become death”

HOW DR. SEUSS FICTIONALLY CREATED HIS BOOKS

Dr. Seuss had a cat
He also had a pig
One pet wore a hat
And the other wore a wig
A lightbulb popped up
His eyes knew where to look
Dr. Seuss grabbed a cup
And started to write a book
He sold his books at a mall
His stories got brighter
Dr. Seuss loves them all
And became a famous writer

SECOND CHANCES

If someone ever made a terrible mistake,
 would you ever give them a second chance?
 A second chance in life for redemption
 and change to be a better person.
 Some people aren't willing to
 grant others a second chance
 even though if the person
 understands their wrong doings.
 However, I believe that as long as
 the other person fully understands
 their mistakes, willing to turn
 their life around for the good
 and better, and promises to not
 make those same mistakes again,
 I would grant them a second chance.
 Now the question is, would you ever
 give someone a second chance no matter
 what wrong doings they did and them owning up?

PROCESS STATEMENT

RELATIONSHIPS CHANGE: This poem is anapest and trimeter (one-syllable words, with each line containing three syllables). I actually made this poem before it was on this google doc. I wrote this poem for my writing assignment: Assignment - Form - July 4. While using the poem, I decided to expand it since I felt like there is more to add. I am honestly happy with the end result because I got to end the poem with a bittersweet ending and reflect on my Existential Loss story that I wrote earlier in this class. I didn't face any challenges when writing this poem. However, if I were to say that could be challenging for this poem is to make it up to 24 lines. But I think dragging it longer isn't necessary for a poem like this because I don't want the poem to drag with unnecessary filler. One thing that I hope that readers can learn from this is that relationships do sadly change but that's okay, similar to my nonfiction story.

OPPENHEIMER: This poem is not in form, instead it's a free verse poem. Funny story, looking at the rubric at this and creating the *RELATIONSHIPS CHANGE* poem, I wanted to create another one that keeps up with a consistent beat. Then I was thinking, "Can you hear the beat" which hit me. I'll create a poem about Oppenheimer when he exploded his huge bomb that he created and how it affected his vision even though people liked it. When it came to writing it, a beat came right into my head. Although when you do the beat on hand, it is not consistent like *RELATIONSHIPS CHANGE*, but it doesn't go too far off with the beat for each line; each getting 5-8 claps. This was the original plan, but since I have two poems that are in form, considering that I couldn't keep a consistent clapping beat. I had to make this poem a free verse. Making the changes wasn't too hard, but I do miss hearing the beat. With the change, the challenging part was knowing if I should expand the poem more or keep it as how I have it. Both will stay in between 8-25 lines, however, I don't like to add filler/unnecessary lines in this poem. So I decided to add some lines just to give it more vivid imagery, especially when it came to the bomb exploding. With this expansion, I used enjambment so I can use vivid imagery more and connect the sentences that match up to what a character is expressing or doing. Even though I wasn't able to get this poem as how I want it to be, I am at least happy with how it ended and luckily, I didn't explode while making changes.

HOW DR. SEUSS FICTIONALLY CREATED HIS BOOKS: This poem is my rhyming one, using Quatrain and Couplets. I honestly could write a rhyming poem that is not Dr. Seuss related, but since his books are good at rhyming like *The Cat in The Hat*, I used his literary writing as a base to start my rhyming poem. I will say, I had fun making this one because it is a fiction poem on how Dr. Seuss made his books. After all, you will never know that looking at something right in front of you can give you a lightbulb idea for a story to write. Not to mention, the new *Cat in the Hat* animated film trailer came out at the time when I made this poem, so I guess you can say this was a perfect time to write a fiction poem about Dr. Seuss. The only challenging thing that I could think of was what to write in for lines 9 and 11 because I want the story to still focus on Dr. Seuss and his books and keeping the beats for all the lines consistent. The majority of the lines are 5 or 6 beats. But overall, I want this poem to focus on rhyming more and it turned out to be a fun poem about Dr. Seuss and his books that I wrote.

SECOND CHANCES: This poem is free verse. Originally, I had this poem in duplex form, but since the rubric wants me to do two poems that are not in form, I decided to make the switch for this poem to be in free verse so it can save me time. I wanted to create one that involves the theme of Second Chances, which follows along with my philosophy. Similar to *OPPENHEIMER*, I did use enjambment here because this type of poem would like sentences that would continue on the next line. I feel like if I don't use enjambment, the poem read by the audience would end up terrible. I like that I made this an open-ended question poem because I know that not everyone will have the same philosophy as me and I want the readers to think about what are some good things that would grant a person a second chance after them doing a bad thing. For example, if Jonah doesn't follow what God tells him to go and admits his wrong decision for not listening to God, would you give Jonah a second chance? I'll be honest, there wasn't really anything challenging about this poem. I should also mention that looking at the structure of the poem, you can see that it is structured like the state of Minnesota.

